

July 2026 — Digital Advertising Report

Search Engine Advertising + Retargeting — Third Full Month

Period: July 1 – July 31, 2026 Reporting date: August 23, 2026

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July marks the program's **third full calendar month** of delivery, and the trend line that matters has now held for three consecutive months: **qualified phone calls and conversion rate keep moving up together**. Impressions rose 5.2% and clicks 5.4% versus June — while phone-call leads climbed from 29 to **31** and the conversion rate edged from 11.1% to **11.3%**. Growth has settled into a steadier, compounding rhythm after the sharper month-one and month-two jumps, which is the expected maturation curve as Google's bidding narrows in on the auctions most likely to produce a call.

July delivered **31 verifiable phone-call leads through Google Search**, plus 27 secondary touchpoints (18 phone calls dialed from the website after an ad click, and 9 form submissions) — **58 tracked search interactions** in all, up from 55 in June. Every figure in this report reflects the **core Google Search program**, which carried the month on its own. The retargeting layers are scheduled to begin in August.

1. Executive Summary

KPIs below reflect the **core Google Search program** — the whole of July's delivery — for clean month-over-month comparison against June and May.

PHONE-CALL LEADS

31

▲ +6.9% vs June (29) · 60s+ qualified

LONG-DURATION CALLS
(90S+)

22

▲ +4.8% vs June (21)

PHONE SHARE

91%

All phone actions ÷ all tracked leads

IMPRESSIONS

34,103

▲ +5.2% vs June (32,417)

CLICKS

275

▲ +5.4% vs June · CTR 0.81%

CONV. RATE

11.3%

▲ from 11.1% in June

Headline: three straight months of rising call volume *and* rising conversion rate. Phone-call leads have gone 15 → 23 → 29 → 31 since the program launched in April — roughly a doubling in four months, while the click volume behind them grew far more modestly. The spend continues to buy better-qualified calls rather than simply more traffic.

2. Conversion Performance

SOURCE	COUNT	NOTES
Calls from Google Ads (primary — 60s+ qualified)	31	The primary conversion metric. Up from 29 in June. A call from someone who clicked a Google ad and stayed on the line past the 60-second qualifying threshold.
Calls from Google Ads — long-duration subset (90s+)	22	Subset of the above (up from 21). Conversations lasting 90+ seconds — a strong signal the call moved past initial qualifying into a real discussion.
Call clicks from website (secondary)	18	Visitor clicked a Google ad, landed on the site, then dialed the number on the page. Tracked as a secondary action.
Form submissions (secondary)	9	Email-form leads. Treated as secondary per program design — this lead type converts to booked appointments at a lower rate than phone calls.
Total tracked interactions (Search)	58	31 primary phone-call leads + 27 secondary touchpoints. Up from 55 in June.

Twenty-two of the thirty-one primary calls ran past ninety seconds — 71% of them, holding the same high proportion as June. That ratio matters more than the headline count on its own: it confirms the calls arriving are homeowners describing an actual problem, not misdials or price-only inquiries. Each of those conversions also feeds back into the bidding model, which is what makes the following month's delivery incrementally sharper.

3. Campaign Performance

CAMPAIGN	IMPR.	CLICKS	CTR	CONV.	CONV. RATE
SRCH — Foundation Repair	19,896	120	0.60%	15	12.5%
SRCH — Water + Crawl	13,446	101	0.75%	13	12.9%
SRCH — Branded	761	54	7.10%	3	5.6%
Total	34,103	275	0.81%	31	11.3%

Conversion counts reflect **primary phone-call leads only**. The 18 website call clicks and 9 form submissions are tracked but not counted in the primary totals, per the program's primary-vs-secondary design.

- **Foundation Repair** — 15 phone-call leads at a 12.5% conversion rate, up from 14 at 12.3%. The largest campaign by impression volume and again the biggest absolute contributor. Its 0.60% click-through rate looks modest, but that is by design: tight match types and eight negative-keyword lists deliberately suppress clicks from browsers and researchers so the budget concentrates on commercial-intent queries.
- **Water + Crawl** — 13 leads at a **12.9% conversion rate**, the program's best efficiency to date and up from 12 at 12.5%. Basement waterproofing and crawl-space encapsulation continue to convert at the highest rate in the account, which fits the summer moisture window precisely.
- **Branded** — 3 leads at 5.6%, with a 7.10% click-through rate. This campaign defends the Guardian name inexpensively and remains a useful barometer: branded search volume ticking up month over month indicates the awareness layers are putting the name in front of more Knox-metro homeowners.

Device performance

DEVICE	IMPR.	CLICKS	CONV.
Mobile	22,706	178	21
Desktop	10,465	88	10
Tablet	932	9	0
Total	34,103	275	31

Mobile again produced the majority of primary calls — 21 of 31 — with desktop contributing a steady 10. The split has been remarkably consistent across all three months, and it reflects how this category

actually behaves: a homeowner notices a crack or a damp crawl space, pulls out a phone on the spot, and calls. The mobile bid adjustment stays in place.

4. Keyword Match-Type Performance

MATCH TYPE	IMPR.	CLICKS	CTR	CONV.	CONV. RATE
EXACT	10,559	110	1.04%	22	20.0%
PHRASE	23,544	165	0.70%	9	5.5%
Total	34,103	275	0.81%	31	11.3%

The four-to-one rule holds: exact-match keywords converted at **20.0%** against phrase-match at **5.5%** — the same roughly four-to-one advantage seen in May and June. Exact match produced 22 of the month's 31 calls from just under a third of the impressions. Phrase match earns its place by catching the real-world variants people actually type ("near me," "contractor near," "cost to fix"), and its conversion rate improved slightly this month from 5.1% to 5.5%. Bidding continues to lean toward the exact terms with proven call history.

5. Weather & Demand Backdrop

Ground conditions drive this business, and July continued the pattern that made June notable. Knox County finished the month **about half an inch above normal on rainfall** — the 44th wettest July in 132 years of record — extending the wet stretch that followed spring's severe drought. Critically, though, **2026 as a whole is still running dry:** January through July ranks as the 65th driest such stretch in that same 132-year record.

Why it matters: that combination — a dry year overall, punctuated by wetter-than-normal summer months — is the soil profile most likely to produce visible foundation problems. East Tennessee's clay-heavy soils contract during the dry stretches and pull away from footings, then swell again when the rain returns, and the repeated cycle is what opens cracks, sticks doors, and pushes moisture into crawl spaces. Homeowners tend to notice the symptoms in exactly this kind of summer, which keeps the demand backdrop favorable heading into fall.

6. Retargeting — Launching in August

The three retargeting channels have been scheduled to begin in **August**. July ran entirely on the core Google Search program, which means the 31 phone-call leads reported above were produced by

Search alone — a useful clean baseline to measure the retargeting contribution against once it starts.

The reasoning behind adding these layers is straightforward: a homeowner almost never calls a foundation contractor the first time they search. They notice a crack, look around, read a little, and come back to it days later. Search captures the moment of the first look; retargeting keeps Guardian present through the days in between.

RETARGETING

Google Demand Gen — Remarketing

What it will do: show Guardian cards on YouTube, Gmail, and Discover to people who have already viewed a service, contact, or financing page — keeping the name in front of them through the consideration window.

Why it matters: a warm audience that has already been on the site converts well above first-time Search traffic.

RETARGETING

Meta (Facebook + Instagram) — Remarketing

What it will do: reach that same site-visitor audience in the Facebook and Instagram feed — catching people during ordinary browsing, away from Google entirely.

Why it matters: it adds a second surface to the same audience, and typically produces form submissions plus an unmeasured "halo" of office calls.

AWARENESS / FEEDER

Meta — Cold Prospecting (Feeder)

What it will do: put the Guardian name in front of Knox-metro homeowners who haven't visited the site yet. Its job is to feed the remarketing audience, not to generate immediate leads.

Why it matters: the two remarketing layers can only work against an audience that exists. This builds it, and is judged on audience growth rather than direct leads.

What to expect: retargeting rarely shows its full value in month one — it needs an audience pool to work against, and that pool builds over several weeks. The realistic read is a modest August contribution growing into September and October, layered on top of a Search program that is already performing.

7. Google Business Profile — Organic Context

Separate from the paid program, Guardian's **Google Business Profile** — the free listing that appears in Google Maps and local search — had its strongest month of the period. Total profile interactions rose from **135 in June to 153 in July**, an increase of about 13% and the highest monthly figure since April. Across the March-through-August window the profile has generated **826 interactions** in total.

Both tracked action types moved up, one of them sharply:

ACTION FROM THE GOOGLE LISTING	JUNE	JULY	CHANGE
Website clicks	38	67	+76.3%
Phone calls	37	46	+24.3%
Total profile interactions	135	153	+13.3%

Website clicks from the listing jumping 76% is the more interesting of the two. It means people finding Guardian on Maps or in local results are increasingly choosing to go look at the site rather than stopping at the listing — deeper engagement, and the behavior of someone researching a contractor rather than making a quick call.

Worth noting: this is organic visibility, entirely distinct from the paid call totals reported above, and it should not be added to them. But it is a meaningful complementary signal. As the paid program raises Guardian's presence across the market, more people are also finding the business directly through its Google listing and acting on it there — the compounding side-effect of sustained advertising that doesn't show up in the ad account itself.

8. August Outlook

The program is now past the 90-day mark that matters most for automated bidding, and July's results show it settling into a steady compounding rhythm rather than the sharper early jumps. On the Search side the priorities are unchanged: keep Foundation Repair and Water + Crawl accumulating call-conversion history, and keep the exact-match terms with proven call records well funded.

The addition for August is the retargeting launch described in Section 6. Because July ran on Search alone, we have a clean baseline to measure it against — any lift from here is attributable rather than assumed.

Late summer into early fall is historically when foundation and crawl-space inquiries pick up — homeowners who noticed a problem during the summer tend to act before winter — and with the soil-

moisture backdrop still favorable, the expectation is continued steady growth in qualified phone-call volume.

On track: phone-call leads have risen every single month since launch — 15, 23, 29, 31 — with the conversion rate climbing alongside at 7.8%, 9.2%, 11.1%, and now 11.3%. Volume and quality improving together over four consecutive months is the clearest evidence the program is working as designed.